

What's Enough For Me? For You? For America?

In a book entitled *Enough.*, you may be wondering: What's enough for Jack Bogle? What's enough for you? And the giant question that looms over the United States today, what's enough for our society?

The idea of enough *wealth* was clearly on Joseph Heller's mind when he commented on Kurt Vonnegut's observation about the financial riches of their billionaire host. But, as you now know, I've taken the idea of *enough* far beyond money, to our business system and to the lives we live. So before I talk about the wealth issue for me, for you, and for the United States, let's think a bit further about the relationship between happiness and success, especially the right kind of success.

Albert Schweitzer got it exactly right. "*Success is not the key to happiness. Happiness is the key to success.*" Honestly, I think that nearly all of us have a pretty good notion of what happiness is, and the extent to which we have found happiness in our lives. And all of us have experienced, to one degree or another, both the joys and sorrows of life, its pleasures and its pains, its bright surprises and its profound disappointments. Yet we come to realize, again, in almost all cases, that "this too shall pass away." So we survive and we move on. By and large, we human beings are a resilient bunch.

Psychologists have pretty accurately described the three major factors that define human happiness. Money, it turns out, does provide happiness, but as we quickly get used to our higher level of material wealth, it turns out to be a transitory sort of happiness. According to an authoritative article in *American Psychologist* magazine, it's not money that determines our happiness, but the presence of some combination of these three attributes: (1) *autonomy*, the extent to which we have the ability to control our own lives, "to do our own thing"; (2) *maintaining connectiveness* with other human beings, in the form of love of our families, our pleasure in friends and colleagues, and an openness with those we meet in all walks of life; and (3) *exercising competence*, using our God-given and self-motivated talents, inspired and striving to learn. Some